Sai Saketh Rambhatla

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Employment

Member of Technical Staff, Skild AI Research, San Mateo Dec 2025 – Present

- Research and development of Vision-Language-Action (VLA) and World Action Models (WAMs) for multi-embodiment robot control, toward generalist robot policies.

Sr. Research Scientist, Meta AI Research, Seattle Oct 2024 – Dec 2025

- Developed techniques for native image and video generation with large language models (LLMs).

Postdoctoral Researcher, Meta AI Research, New York Jan 2023 – Oct 2024

- Developed generative AI techniques for **generation** (Movie Gen, Emu Video, InstanceDiffusion) and **evaluation** (SelfEval).

Education

PhD in Electrical Engineering, University of Maryland, College Park Aug 2016 – Dec 2022

- Advisors: Rama Chellappa and Abhinav Shrivastava
- Thesis: Towards In-the-Wild Visual Understanding

Master's in Electrical Engineering, University of Maryland, College Park Aug 2016 – Dec 2021

- Advisor: Rama Chellappa

Dual Degree in Electrical Engineering, Indian Institute of Technology, Kharagpur Jun 2011 – Jun 2016

- Advisors: Pranab Kumar Datta and Rajeev Ranjan Sahay
- Thesis: Body Pose Classification using Deep Learning

Selected Publications

- Toward Diffusible High-Dimensional Latent Spaces: A Frequency Perspective
  Bolin Lai, Xudong Wang, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, James M. Rehg, Zsolt Kira, Rohit Girdhar, Ishan Misra
  Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR), 2026
- Trokens: Semantic-Aware Relational Trajectory Tokens for Few-Shot Action Recognition
  Pulkit Kumar, Shuaiyi Huang, Matthew Walmer, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Abhinav Shrivastava
  International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV), 2025
- MotiF: Making Text Count in Image Animation with Motion Focal Loss
  Shijie Wang, Samaneh Azadi, Rohit Girdhar, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Chen Sun, Xi Yin
  Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR), 2025
- Diffusion Autoencoders are Scalable Image Tokenizers
  Yinbo Chen, Rohit Girdhar, Xiaolong Wang, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Ishan Misra
  arXiv preprint arXiv:2501.18593, 2025
- Movie Gen: A Cast of Media Foundation Models
  Meta Movie Gen team — Core contributor
  arXiv preprint arXiv:2410.13720, 2024
- Emu Video: Factorizing Text-to-Video Generation by Explicit Image Conditioning
  Rohit Girdhar, Mannat Singh, Andrew Brown, Quentin Duval, Samaneh Azadi, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Mian Akbar Shah, Xi Yin, Devi Parikh, Ishan Misra
  European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV), 2024

- SelfEval: Leveraging the Discriminative Nature of Generative Models for Evaluation
  Sai Saketh Rambhatla, Ishan Misra
  Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR), 2024
- InstanceDiffusion: Instance-level Control for Image Generation
  Xudong Wang, Trevor Darrell, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Rohit Girdhar, Ishan Misra
  Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR), 2024
- MOST: Multiple Object Localization with Self-Supervised Transformers for Object Discovery
  Sai Saketh Rambhatla, Ishan Misra, Rama Chellappa, Abhinav Shrivastava
  International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV), 2023
- SparseDet: Improving Sparsely Annotated Object Detection with Pseudo-positive Mining
  Sai Saketh Rambhatla*, Saksham Suri*, Rama Chellappa, Abhinav Shrivastava
  International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV), 2023
- An Empirical Analysis of Boosting Neural Networks
  Sai Saketh Rambhatla, Michael Jones, Rama Chellappa
  International Joint Conference on Neural Networks (IJCNN), 2022
- The Pursuit of Knowledge: Discovering and Localizing New Concepts using Dual Memory
  Sai Saketh Rambhatla, Rama Chellappa, Abhinav Shrivastava
  International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV), 2021
- Towards Discovery and Attribution of Open-world GAN Generated Images
  Saksham Suri*, Sharath Girish*, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Abhinav Shrivastava
  International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV), 2021
- Detecting Human-Object Interactions using Functional Common-Sense
  Ankan Bansal, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Abhinav Shrivastava, Rama Chellappa
  AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI), 2020
- A Dual-Path Model with Adaptive Attention for Vehicle Re-Identification
  Pirazh Khorramshahi, Amit Kumar, Neehar Peri, **Sai Saketh Rambhatla**, Jun-Cheng Chen, Rama Chellappa
  International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV), 2019
- Body Part Alignment and Temporal Attention for Video-Based Person Re-Identification
  Sai Saketh Rambhatla, Michael Jones
  British Machine Vision Conference (BMVC), 2019

Research Internships

Cruise AI, San Francisco (2022) Advisors: Dr. Xiao Zhang, Dr. Carl Vondrick
Developed efficient algorithms for continual self-supervised learning.

Mitsubishi Electric Research Laboratory, Boston (2018, 2019) Advisor: Dr. Mike Jones
Worked on video-based person re-identification and ensembles of deep neural networks.

Awards

- Awarded the **Ann G. Wylie Dissertation Fellowship** for the academic year 2021–22.
- Selected for the A. James Clark School of Engineering **Future Faculty Cohort** for the academic year 2021–22.
- Awarded the prestigious **George Corcoran Award** for excellence in teaching for the academic year 2017–18.
- Awarded **Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award** for the academic year 2017–18.
- Awarded **Outstanding Reviewer** for CVPR 2021 and NeurIPS 2023.
- Awarded **Best Paper Award (Honorable Mention)** at ANTS 2016, Bangalore.

Academic Service

Reviewing

- CVPR ('19–'26), ECCV ('20–'26), ICCV ('19–'25), ICLR ('23–'25), NeurIPS ('23–'25), ICML ('24)
- IJCV, T-PAMI, Pattern Recognition Letters